

PictureRoute

Directions as a picture story: “Turn left at the big clock tower.”

The Idea

Many people don’t navigate with maps; they navigate with landmarks. Kids, older adults, people with cognitive disabilities, tourists who don’t read the local language, and anyone who finds maps confusing. PictureRoute turns a route into an illustrated, step-by-step story: each step is a picture card of the landmark where you turn, with a short spoken instruction from Grok Voice. Grok Imagine creates the illustrations in a consistent, friendly style.

Track Fit

Built with Cursor	Route processing, card generation, and UI built in Cursor.
Grok Voice / Imagine	Imagine is the core (illustrated cards); Voice reads each step. Uses both.
Space data	Not used.
Navigation theme	Direct fit; a new way to give directions.
Also eligible	Big Red, Design, People’s Choice.

Features

MVP

- Enter start and destination; get walking directions.
- Find a nearby landmark at each turn (from map place data).
- Generate an illustrated card per step with Grok Imagine.
- Swipeable card deck with spoken instructions.

Stretch

- Printable directions sheet (for people without smartphones).
- Multiple languages.
- A caregiver mode that sends a route to a family member’s phone.

Tech Stack and Data

- Routing and landmarks: Google Maps Directions + Places APIs, or OpenStreetMap.
- Frontend: React card deck; mobile-first design.
- AI: Grok Imagine for cards; Grok Voice for narration.

Limitations and Risks

- **Generated pictures are not the real place.** An illustration of “the clock tower” may look nothing like the real one, which could confuse exactly the people it’s meant to help.
Mitigation: Use real Street View or place photos as the main image; use Imagine for style or icons. Say so in the pitch.
- **Generation is slow and costs money.** Generating many images per route takes time and API credits.
Mitigation: Generate cards in parallel, cache by landmark, and pre-generate the demo route.
- **Landmark choice is hard.** The nearest place in the map data is often not the most visible one (an office instead of a big statue).
Mitigation: Prefer certain categories (parks, monuments, big stores); let users swap a landmark.
- **Untested with target users.** Real benefit for older adults or people with cognitive disabilities isn’t proven.
Mitigation: Frame the demo around a clear persona and keep the claims modest.
- **Grok API unknowns.** Image style consistency and generation speed are not verified.
Mitigation: Test Imagine Friday night on 5 sample landmarks.

Scorecard

Demo-able	4/5	Beautiful card deck on screen.
Buildable in 24h	4/5	API integration plus design work.
Navigation theme	4/5	New take on directions.
Wow factor	4/5	Strong visuals; best Imagine use.
Technical risk (5 = riskiest)	2/5	Low to moderate.

Verdict

Best pick for a design-strong team. The most natural use of Grok Imagine, and a contender for the Design track. Be honest about image accuracy.